Protein

The RDA for an adult necessities a protein intake of 0.8g/kg of body weight making the total protein. This amount of protein provides about 13-15% of the total calorie.

Carbohydrates

About 50-60% of the total diet calories should come from carbohydrate foods, with the majority being mostly complex carbohydrates such as starches. Easily absorbed sugars may also be used for immediate energy.

Fat

It provides a back-up energy source. Sufficient fat makes food taste better, aids appetite and provides needed kcal to prevent excessive weight loss.

Calcium and Phosphorus

In adults, calcium is required for replacing calcium lost from body through urine, feces, sweat and bile. Of the dietary calcium only 20-30% is absorbed and this is facilitated by vitamin D. A desirable intake of phosphorus is recommended. The elemental Ca:P ratio in the diet should be maintained at 1:1.

Iron

The loss of iron through sweat, gastrointestinal tract and urine is estimated to be 14 mg/kg body weight. Apart from this women have additional loss due to menstruation. Thus the iron requirements for women are more than men.

Vitamins

Studies have revealed that 600 mg of retinol daily would be sufficient to maintain a normal serum vitamin A level. The requirement for B Vitamins is based on calorie intake. Requirement of folic acid among Indians is 200µg.A daily intake of 20 mg vitamin C is sufficient to maintain ascorbic acid status. Since 50 percent

Table 12 Balanced Diet for Adults - Sedentary/ Moderate/ Heavy Activity

S. No	Food Groups	Portion g/Day	Activity					
			Sedentary		Moderate		Heavy	
			Man	Women	Man	Women	Man	Women
			Number Of Portions					
1.	Cereals And Millets	30	12.5	9	15	11	20	16
2.	Pules	30	2.5	2	3	2.5	4	3
3.	Milk	100ml	3	3	3	3	3	3
4.	Roots And Tubers	100	2	2	2	2	2	2
5.	Green Leafy Vegetables	100	1	1	1	1	1	1
6.	Other Vegetables	100	2	2	2	2	2	2
7.	Fruits	100	1	1	1	1	1	1
8.	Sugar	5	4	4	6	6	11	9
9.	Fats/ Oil Visible	5	5	4	6	5	8	6

Source: Dietary Guidelines for Indians A Manual, NIN, Hyderabad (2011).

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